

Prahl Portfolio Work Log - August 24, 2026

Compiled summary for Monday, August 24, 2026 - focus: continuing the Prahl.dev Portfolio Alla Vostra project-page refinement after the August 16 UX Product Flow and UI hierarchy pass, verifying the United States Eastern date, reviewing all prior Portfolio PDF worklogs, running the customary project reader, removing the UI Foundations Visual Hierarchy Tutorial subsection and its empty-frame asset, rebuilding the Pre-Scrolling Visual Hierarchy presentation around primary, secondary, tertiary, and quaternary stacks, tuning vertical Viewing Area and Focal Point braces, adding white-line and green-eyebrow callouts for app header, nav bar, hero, product image, main content, and shopping cart regions, preserving narrow and portrait annotations, validating hover/tap magnification and static export behavior, checking the Hostinger GitHub Actions run state, refreshing the Portfolio project snapshot, and generating the August 24 Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahl Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, work-completed sections, validation section, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.

This artifact intentionally covers Prahl/portfolio work performed after portfolio_worklog_august16.pdf and after the August 16 documentation state. The source commit reviewed for this record is c8a0a0080db246a6f5fddfa6c765c9adad364758 on main, matching origin/main before this PDF was generated. That commit contains the Alla Vostra UI Foundations Visual Hierarchy source and asset changes described here. The GitHub Actions Hostinger static-export workflow run for that push was checked and failed before the build job started because the account was locked due to a billing issue; local TypeScript and static-export validation both passed. The only local source delta before this PDF was generated was the refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt documentation snapshot.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Verified the United States Eastern date with TZ=America/New_York date, which reported Monday, August 24, 2026 at 11:19 PM EDT during the worklog pass. The user then confirmed that the worklog should use August 24 rather than the UTC date already visible in response headers.
- Ran ./read_project.sh from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio and regenerated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt before writing this worklog, preserving the project convention that Codex refreshes the current source snapshot before continuing Portfolio documentation work.
- Reviewed the refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt, including project notes, source tree, public image inventories, PDF worklog inventory, package and deployment configuration, current git context, recent commits, ignored generated paths, and the standing instruction to ask for a commit message before committing or pushing.
- Reviewed every pre-existing Portfolio root-level worklog PDF:
portfolio_worklog_july11.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july14.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_july15_part1.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july15_part2.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_july16.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july19.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_july20.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july21.pdf,
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portfolio_worklog_august3.pdf, portfolio_worklog_august4.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_august5.pdf, portfolio_worklog_august6.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_august10_part1.pdf, portfolio_worklog_august10_part2.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_august11.pdf, portfolio_worklog_august12_part1.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_august12_part2.pdf, portfolio_worklog_august14.pdf, and
portfolio_worklog_august16.pdf.

- Extracted text from all twenty-nine existing Portfolio PDFs with pdftotext to preserve title cadence, same-day part naming, opening-summary density, section order, bullet-heavy technical voice, validation language, files-touched lists, follow-up context, output-artifact close, and root-level filename style.
- Checked recent PDF metadata with pdfinfo and pdffonts. The mature Portfolio artifacts use letter-size pages, PDF 1.4 output, Helvetica Type 1 text, Codex author/creator/producer metadata, no custom metadata stream, and root-level filenames in the portfolio_worklog_monthday pattern.
- Used portfolio_worklog_august16.pdf as the closest chronological baseline, with portfolio_worklog_august14.pdf and portfolio_worklog_august12_part2.pdf as the closest Visual Hierarchy structural references because they documented the prior tutorial row, focus variants, cream fades, cache-clearing pattern, browser measurement workflow, and documentation language.
- Reviewed git history and state through git log, git show --stat, git show --name-status, git branch -vv, git status, git diff --stat, the refreshed snapshot, package scripts, npm validation output, local route checks, and GitHub Actions run history. HEAD and origin/main resolved to c8a0a00 before this PDF was generated.
- Reviewed app/projects/alla-vostra/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx, app/globals.css, portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt, the removed public/images/alla-vostra-empty-framed-no-island.png asset path, the local /projects/alla-vostra route, and the current root-level Portfolio PDF inventory.

Baseline Status Before August 24 Work

- August 16 left the Portfolio project with the Alla Vostra UX Product Flow diagram and screenshot-flow sections reorganized around Tutorial, Browse, SHOP, Cart, Checkout, and Confirmation, plus Visual Hierarchy Step 2 removed from UI Foundations.
- The UI Foundations Visual Hierarchy section still carried the earlier Tutorial subsection context from the August 12 and August 14 passes, including a blank empty-frame asset that no longer matched the desired Pre-Scrolling hierarchy story.
- The Pre-Scrolling Visual Hierarchy row had primary, secondary, tertiary, and quaternary imagery, but the user wanted the Tutorial subsection removed completely and wanted the remaining Pre-Scrolling layout treated as the active refinement area.
- The primary Viewing Area annotation, braces, white section lines, and green eyebrow callouts needed repeated spacing, orientation, centering, and clipping adjustments so the labels read vertically while still tracking the real phone/screenshot geometry.
- The secondary, tertiary, and quaternary stacks needed to keep their wide two-column-per-row aspect ratio scale in narrow and portrait windows, rather than collapsing into square-ish or clipped preview behavior.
- The secondary and tertiary captions, quaternary image placement, sibling stack spacing, and focal-point labels needed visual hierarchy cleanup after the user removed the word FOCUS from the stack headers.
- Narrow and portrait modes needed to retain the annotation system for review, show one device-frame or screenshot stack column per row, and preserve enough left/right breathing room for braces and green callouts without forcing equal page margins.
- The local development server and cache state needed active management because rapid Visual Hierarchy CSS/JSX changes could appear stale until .next output was cleared and the dev server was restarted.

Goals for August 24

- Remove the Visual Hierarchy Tutorial subsection and its unused blank tutorial asset completely from the Alla Vostra Portfolio page.
- Rebuild the Pre-Scrolling subsection around the four sibling stacks: PRIMARY, SECONDARY, TERTIARY, and QUATERNARY, without the previous FOCUS suffix in the visible headers.
- Make Viewing Area and Focal Point read vertically, keep those labels centered against their respective braces, and prevent text or brace strokes from clipping into each other.

- Add and tune white-line plus green-eyebrow callouts for app header, nav bar, hero, product image, main content, and shopping cart regions, including line-wrapped two-word labels and adjusted line spacing.
- Preserve stack imagery aspect ratios and screenshot-preview magnification in narrow and portrait layouts, especially for the secondary and tertiary protected compositions and the quaternary product image.
- Align the primary stack with its secondary, tertiary, and quaternary siblings, then tune vertical gaps so the four-stack sequence reads cleanly in portrait review.
- Add focal-point braces and vertical Focal Point labels beside the secondary, tertiary, and quaternary Pre-Scrolling stacks, matching the Viewing Area brace thickness and typography while accommodating different visual heights.
- Keep the work local until the user requested otherwise, clear development caches when requested, validate with TypeScript, Playwright, local route checks, and static export, refresh the snapshot, and produce the August 24 PDF worklog.

Work Completed - Tutorial Removal and Pre-Scrolling Structure

- Removed the Tutorial subsection from the UI Foundations Visual Hierarchy sequence and row-label set so the section now begins with PRE-SCROLLING instead of showing an empty Tutorial primary stack.
- Deleted public/images/alla-vostra-empty-framed-no-island.png, the blank Tutorial frame asset that had been introduced for the earlier Visual Hierarchy Tutorial placeholder row.
- Removed the Tutorial-specific source wiring from ProductFlowSwitcher so the deleted asset is no longer referenced by the Visual Hierarchy renderer.
- Simplified the Visual Hierarchy focus title copy from PRIMARY FOCUS, SECONDARY FOCUS, TERTIARY FOCUS, and QUATERNARY FOCUS to PRIMARY, SECONDARY, TERTIARY, and QUATERNARY while preserving horizontal centering.
- Removed requested Pre-Scrolling captions, including Step 1 Large screenshot and Step 1d Large screenshot, and later removed secondary and tertiary stack captions so the visual hierarchy reads through the stack headers and annotations instead of redundant figcaptions.
- Preserved the underlying Step ids and CSS class hooks, including Step 1, Step 1b, Step 1c, and Step 1d, so the visual labels could change without destabilizing deterministic layout selectors.
- Reworked the row-order assumptions after removing Tutorial so PRE-SCROLLING, ON-SCROLLING, and DURING SHOPPING headers continue to occupy the intended visual sequence.

Work Completed - Primary Viewing Area and Section Callouts

- Changed the primary Pre-Scrolling Viewing Area annotation into a single non-wrapping vertical label that reads like the focal labels rather than line-wrapping Viewing and Area separately.
- Tuned the Viewing Area text and brace cluster so the label-to-brace gap and brace-to-device-frame gap match the focal-point stack rhythm in narrow, portrait, and desktop measurements.
- Added PRODUCT IMAGE to the primary callout set alongside APP HEADER, NAV BAR, HERO, MAIN CONTENT, and SHOPPING CART so the cheeseboard/product region is named consistently across all four Pre-Scrolling stacks.
- Converted the green eyebrow headers beside the primary device-frame/screenshot stack into vertical labels, centered them on their white line markers, and kept two-word labels line-wrapped rather than cramped horizontally.
- Reduced and then retuned kerning for APP HEADER and NAV BAR after the user called out crowding beside the device-frame/screenshot stack.
- Increased spacing between image edges, white line markers, and green eyebrow labels after the initial larger-eyebrow pass felt cramped, then adjusted two-line label leading so APP HEADER, NAV BAR, PRODUCT IMAGE, MAIN CONTENT, and SHOPPING CART remained readable.

- Retained the primary braces, green eyebrow headers, and white line callouts in narrow and portrait modes so the user could evaluate the annotation system directly on small windows.

Work Completed - Secondary, Tertiary, and Quaternary Stack Treatments

- Recentered all visible image/color assets under the PRIMARY, SECONDARY, TERTIARY, and QUATERNARY headers in narrow and portrait views while allowing the brace/text annotation assets to use unequal page-edge margins when necessary.
- Horizontally aligned the primary stack with its secondary, tertiary, and quaternary siblings after the first portrait pass left the primary device frame visually offset from the smaller stack column.
- Scaled the secondary, tertiary, and quaternary visible assets upward so their combined treatment filled the vertical region established by the primary device-frame/screenshot stack while maintaining the accepted vertical gaps between the three smaller stacks.
- Preserved the wide two-columns-per-row aspect-ratio scale for the secondary, tertiary, and quaternary imagery during portfolio/narrow windows, preventing portrait mode from square-ifying the detail imagery.
- Maintained hover and tap magnification for composed screenshot stacks without clipping the secondary and tertiary images or losing their protected image/fade presentation.
- Moved the quaternary product image closer to the QUATERNARY header until its spacing matched the secondary and tertiary stack rhythm.
- Moved the quaternary PRODUCT IMAGE white line and green eyebrow closer in portrait and narrow modes so its spacing matched the established landscape/wide-mode placement.
- Doubled the vertical space between the four Pre-Scrolling sibling stacks in portfolio/narrow views after the first one-column flow felt too compressed.

Work Completed - White Lines, Green Eyebrows, and Label Placement

- Added APP HEADER, NAV BAR, HERO, and PRODUCT IMAGE callouts to the secondary stack at vertical positions matching the visual regions of the clipped screenshot.
- Added HERO and PRODUCT IMAGE callouts to the tertiary stack at positions matching its photo/product crop.
- Added PRODUCT IMAGE callout treatment to the quaternary stack and tuned the white line and green text so the marker sits level with the cheeseboard image instead of drifting relative to the cream field.
- Introduced left/right side support for Visual Hierarchy section line callouts so labels could move to the side that avoided clipping while preserving the line-to-image geometry.
- Revisited the secondary NAV BAR callout after an initial side/orientation experiment and restored its placement with the same close spacing as the other secondary callouts.
- Line-wrapped every two-word green eyebrow, increased the eyebrow sizes, then reduced them by 20 percent after the result felt too large, preserving improved line spacing for the two-row labels.
- Balanced the distance between images and white lines with the distance between white lines and green labels, responding to the user review that the first pass was cramped and uneven.
- Kept white and green annotation assets from clipping into their brackets, braces, or line markers while preserving horizontal centering from the labels own rotated point of view.

Work Completed - Focal Point Braces and Annotation System

- Added focal-point brace stacks to the left of secondary, tertiary, and quaternary Pre-Scrolling examples, choosing full-height or compressed brace paths according to each image treatments vertical height.
- Added per-brace annotation styling so Focal Point could read vertically like Viewing Area while still using the shared external annotation rendering pathway.

- Increased the focal-point brace outline and inner stroke widths to visually match the Viewing Area brace after accounting for the half-scale rendering of secondary, tertiary, and quaternary stacks.
- Matched the rendered Focal Point text size to the Viewing Area text size and kept both labels on a vertical reading axis.
- Repositioned the quaternary focal brace and Focal Point text horizontally so they share the same left-side lane as secondary and tertiary instead of sitting too far left due to the wider quaternary image canvas.
- Nudged the quaternary focal brace and Focal Point text downward so the brace center aligns with the cream radial gradient center rather than the broader image-frame center.
- Preserved the brace path shape, vector-effect non-scaling stroke behavior, and stroke outline structure while changing only offsets, widths, and path translation values needed for visual alignment.

Work Completed - Responsive Layout, Cache Handling, and Commit Context

- Updated narrow and portrait Visual Hierarchy layout behavior so device-frame and screenshot stacks render as one stack column per row while keeping the right-column aspect-scale treatment for secondary, tertiary, and quaternary imagery.
- Kept the local Next.js development server available at <http://127.0.0.1:3000> for user review throughout the local visual pass.
- Cleared stale development output when requested by moving .next aside rather than deleting it outright, restarted the portfolio-dev screen session, stopped the stale old Next process, and confirmed the refreshed server responded on port 3000.
- Used Playwright to switch to UI Foundations, scroll to the Visual Hierarchy group, capture focused screenshots, inspect computed transforms, measure label and brace bounding boxes, check line/label spacing, and verify no horizontal overflow at narrow widths.
- Recommended the user-requested commit message in one header followed by hyphen-points. The source state reviewed for this worklog is now committed and pushed as c8a0a00, Refined Alla Vostra visual hierarchy flow.
- Checked the GitHub Actions run triggered by c8a0a00. The Build static export for Hostinger workflow failed before job start with the annotation that the account is locked due to a billing issue, so no successful Hostinger deployment was confirmed from that run.
- Ran ./read_project.sh again for this August 24 worklog-generation pass, updating portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt to the current project tree, git context, PDF inventory, source state, and local documentation status.

Validation Summary

- npm run check passed during the August 24 source pass and again during the worklog-generation pass, confirming TypeScript succeeded with tsc --noEmit.
- npm run build:static passed locally during the worklog-generation pass, with Next.js 16.2.10 compiling successfully and prerendering /, /articles, /projects/alla-vostra, and /projects/cinerific as static routes.
- curl -I <http://127.0.0.1:3000/projects/alla-vostra> returned HTTP 200 OK while the local dev server was running on port 3000.
- Playwright measurements at 360px, 430px, and desktop widths confirmed no horizontal overflow after the Pre-Scrolling annotation system was retained in narrow and portrait modes.
- Browser measurements confirmed Focal Point labels rendered with the same vertical transform direction as Viewing Area and matched the same visible text height after the small-stack zoom was accounted for.
- Browser measurements confirmed secondary, tertiary, and quaternary focal brace strokes visually matched the Viewing Area brace thickness despite the small stacks being rendered at half-scale.
- Browser measurements confirmed the quaternary Focal Point label and brace moved into

the same horizontal lane as the secondary and tertiary focal markers, with near-matching label-to-brace gaps.

- Browser measurements confirmed the quaternary focal brace centerline was aligned to the cream radial gradient center after the downward nudge.
- Browser measurements confirmed the primary Viewing Area brace cluster used focal-style spacing, with label-to-brace and brace-to-device-frame gaps matching the smaller focal stacks within small visual tolerances.
- Playwright screenshots confirmed the primary, secondary, tertiary, and quaternary Pre-Scrolling stack sequence remained readable in portrait review with vertical annotations, green eyebrow callouts, white line markers, and doubled sibling gaps.
- gh run list and gh run view confirmed the c8a0a00 Hostinger workflow run existed but failed before the job started due to the billing-lock account annotation. This was treated as an external CI/account issue rather than a local build failure because npm run build:static passed locally.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- app/projects/alla-vostra/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx: removed the Visual Hierarchy Tutorial Step 0 behavior, added side-aware section callout support, added Pre-Scrolling secondary/tertiary/quaternary callout data, added PRODUCT IMAGE labels, added per-stack focal brace data and vertical annotation styling, changed Viewing Area to a single non-wrapping vertical label, hid requested captions, and kept the Visual Hierarchy visible step limit tied to the active step list.
- app/globals.css: rebuilt Visual Hierarchy responsive placement after Tutorial removal, preserved one-stack-per-row narrow behavior, tuned primary/secondary/tertiary/quaternary stack dimensions, centered visible assets, added vertical callout styling, adjusted eyebrow sizing and leading, matched Viewing Area and Focal Point brace/text spacing, matched focal brace thickness to the primary brace, aligned quaternary focal placement, and retained annotations in portrait review.
- public/images/alla-vostra-empty-framed-no-island.png: deleted the unused blank Visual Hierarchy Tutorial frame asset after the Tutorial subsection was removed.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt: refreshed by read_project.sh to document the current project tree, git state, worklog inventory, generated/cache ignore policy, public asset inventory, validation context, and documentation pass.
- portfolio_worklog_august24.pdf: generated as the new root-level PDF worklog artifact for this August 24 Portfolio session.

Follow-Up Context

- The latest committed source state before this PDF was generated is c8a0a00 on main and origin/main, titled Refined Alla Vostra visual hierarchy flow.
- The only local changes after the documentation refresh and PDF-generation pass should be portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt and portfolio_worklog_august24.pdf. Generated .next and out output remained local build/dev artifacts and were not intended source changes.
- The UI Foundations Visual Hierarchy section now begins with PRE-SCROLLING and no longer includes the Tutorial subsection or blank tutorial frame asset.
- Future Pre-Scrolling edits should preserve the current four-stack taxonomy: PRIMARY, SECONDARY, TERTIARY, and QUATERNARY, with PRODUCT IMAGE used as the product-region label across all four stacks.
- Future changes to secondary and tertiary focal imagery should remeasure the protected composition and hover-preview behavior before changing masks, fade stops, or width assumptions, because the current no-clipping behavior depends on those proportions.
- Future changes to quaternary should distinguish between the full image-frame center and the cream radial gradient center. The focal brace now intentionally tracks the cream field center rather than the broader transparent image canvas.
- The local server remains the safest visual review surface for this page at <http://127.0.0.1:3000>, with the UI Foundations tab selected before inspecting Visual

Hierarchy DOM or screenshots.

- The GitHub Actions Hostinger static-export workflow is currently blocked by a billing-lock issue. A later deployment-verification pass should recheck Actions after that account state is resolved.
- No additional commit was made during this worklog-generation pass after the user asked for the August 24 PDF. The project convention remains to ask the user for a commit message before committing or pushing documentation artifacts.

Output Artifact

- Generated: /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_august24.pdf
- Companion sync file: /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt
- Source state reviewed: c8a0a0080db246a6f5fddfa6c765c9adad364758 on main and origin/main.
- Naming follows the existing root-level Portfolio convention: portfolio_worklog_august24.pdf. No Part suffix was used because no earlier August 24 Portfolio worklog PDF existed.
- The document records the August 24 Alla Vostra Visual Hierarchy tutorial-removal, Pre-Scrolling stack, responsive annotation, white-line/green-eyebrow, focal-brace, cache-clearing, validation, workflow-status, snapshot-refresh, and documentation work in the established Prahlin Portfolio worklog format.